

The Gazette Looking back

100 years ago - January 4, 1901

Alex Patterson was fined \$40 in Belleville for killing his horse which had balked, by hitting it on the head with a wagon stake.

For attacking Solomon Abdon, A Syrian pedlar of Carleton Place, Alexander and Ephraim Hunter were brought before Magistrate Eady, of Renfrew. Alexander Hunter pleaded guilty and was fined \$5.15, including costs. The case against Ephraim Hunter was adjourned.

While going to Perth on Christmas night, after visiting his parents here, Mr. Wm. Young slipped and fell on the ice, dislocating his ankle, and has been laid up since at Barrie's Hotel in Perth.

Ernest Wallace has been sentenced to 14 years in the penitentiary for maliciously driving into Mr. Zufeldt's wagon, permanently crippling the occupant.

50 years ago - January 4, 1951

Appetites jaded by too much turkey received just the right fillip on Saturday evening when the word spread by the grape vine route that Lewis Carr had owlburgers for sale.

The new Council for 1951 was sworn in at the inaugural meeting on Tuesday night. All members were there and only the reeve's chair was vacant. The Council consists of Mayor Alex McDonald and Messrs. Albert Gale, Howard Davey, Wm. Wrigglesworth, Jas. Abram, Thorpe Kelly and Jack Watson.

An attempt to effect a compromise on the assessment controversy that has arisen between the Public Utilities Commission and the Town was made at the first meeting of the new Council Tuesday night. It failed because it was not approved by the Department of Municipal Affairs in Toronto.

Almonte and Carleton Place Baptist Churches are uniting on a trial basis for 16 months. Rev. Arthur Hirtle, minister of the Almonte church, will take the services in both towns. Service in Carleton Place on Sunday will be at 10 a.m. and in Almonte at 11:30 a.m.

25 years ago - January 8, 1976

Dr. Jerry Casey of Almonte, a scientist with the Defence Research Board, was elected chairman of the recently re-activated Almonte Industrial Commission at the inaugural meeting of the organization held in December.

About 80 persons, representing every age group, gathered at the Almonte Public Library the evening of Monday, December 29th, to honor Miss Elizabeth Kelly, who retired on December 31st after serving as librarian here since 1939.

Mr. Don Buchan, of RR3 Almonte, officially took over his duties Monday as the new arena manager at the Almonte Community Centre complex. Buchan's application was selected last week by the Arena Management Committee. Don has been involved in minor hockey during the past several years.

10 years ago - January 2, 1991

After years of watching and participating in Lanark County council business, Almonte Reeve Paul Finner now has the top job. Mr. Finner was acclaimed county warden Dec. 18 and succeeds Carl Ferguson. At 53 years of age, he is one of the youngest wardens the county has seen in several years. Mr. Finner said he feels his youthfulness will be an asset.

Treacherous road conditions are being cited by police as a contributing factor in a tragic pre-Christmas collision just west of Carleton Place which resulted in the death of a Perth man. Dead is Jeffrey Cardinal, 30, of RR6 Perth.

Special occasion permits may soon be things of the past for many events held in the Pakenham arena hall now that the hall will be licensed. Councillor Denny Ferguson told members of Pakenham Township council Dec. 18 there have been discussions about "licensing the hall as a permanent licensed area. Up until now, any event held in the hall required a special occasion permit in order for alcohol to be served.

COLUMNS



On the road again.

Photo by Lianne Lahaie

New Year's blessing brings hope

FROM THE HEART

By Mary Cook



It seems to me Thanksgiving and New Year's should be celebrated together. I know it would really confuse everyone, but when you think about it, New Year's is the time to be thankful, not some day we remember from the 1600s when the Plymouth Colony decided to set aside a day in which to show thanks, and in the United States at that! It was much later that we in Canada decided there was need for a special day to voice our thanks as well.

All that being said, doesn't it make more sense, as a year draws to a close to be thankful that we once again made it through the last 12 months? Some of us are married, scarred and tattooed, but at least, we made it!

Not everyone, of course, can put the wraps on what could be considered another bumper year. Not everyone saw their financial portfolios climb to a staggering height. Not everyone got through the last 12 months without at least one or two trips to the hospital, doctor, emergency room, the dentist, the chiropractor, the eye doctor, marriage councillor, psychiatrist, or a good lawyer. But if you visited one, or several, of the above and lived to tell the tale, isn't that something to be thankful for?

As the calendar is updated on our desks, and a new one hung in the kitchen, if you are like me, you diligently make a list of New Year's resolutions. I have done this for years. And I will do it again. And at the first of the year I attack that list with a vengeance, determined that this year things will be different. I will make a concerted and honest effort to bring about real change in my life, I promise myself. But by mid February something drastic happens. The resolutions become "if I have time, I'll get around to it. If not this year, then next year for sure".

It is usually around that time that I take a long hard look at the resolutions and the year that has just passed. And I determine that even without completing my year 2000 resolutions, it was a pretty good

year anyway.

I am truly thankful for all the good things I enjoy every day. This is above and beyond all those blessings most people enjoy. And I know I am not an isolated case when I say that family and friends are amongst my most cherished blessings. But to go beyond those familiar things which gladden our hearts, I think it is at this time of year that we can be truly thankful for this rich and democratic land we live in. And even though I often am critical of our governments at all levels, like everyone else who has chosen Canada as home, we are blessed that we are allowed to criticize. It is our democratic right to voice our opinion. And this is a right that many people in the world are denied.

We have just come through a Federal election, and even though it

may not have produced the desired result for everyone, it nonetheless gave us the opportunity to choose according to our own personal belief and preference.

There is no doubt that the past year has also seen many tragic and devastating losses for many Canadians. A loss of a loved one, a home, a business, are all tragedies and no amount of optimism or cheerful outlook will ease the pain for those who have suffered through these adversities. But we, when we roll into the year 2001, can make a New Year's resolution that shouldn't be all that difficult to keep. Let us all look to those around us who have suffered a loss of any kind and reach out with the hand of friendship to help ease their way. Let every one of us resolve to do our bit to make this country a truly compassionate place to live.

And to each of you, may you be able to reflect back and be assured that as the months go by, you have done your best to reach out and touch the lives of those around you. That surely will be the best New Year's resolution of all. And may life's richest blessings be with all of you.

End of year snow brings out the birds

Strictly for the Birds

By Lynda C. Bennett
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Happy New Year! Good birding for the year 2001. Wonderful winter at the end of the year brings lots of birds to our feeders. The feeders need to be kept well stocked, and cleaned in between times, as much as possible. Returning from town on Sunday morning, nothing was stirring except a flock of 30 snow buntings feeding on the road after the snowplough had made a path for vehicles.

We finally had birds come in to the feeders. Many American goldfinches, a downy and a hairy woodpecker, black-capped chickadees and a white-breasted nuthatch were enjoying the birdseed. A female northern cardinal has been visiting us the last few days, and the bird had a hard time deciding where to land to pick up food. She normally feeds on the ground below the feeder, but with all the snow that has arrived Sunday, there was no place open on the ground.

The single mourning dove that has been with us and even the blue jays are late today. It must be normal winter behavior.

The two National Audubon Christmas Bird Counts in which we take part had enough birds, but the number of species was a bit lower than usual. Since we haven't had as

snowy and cold a winter as this year, in several previous years, the birds have likely gone further south, or have found their food supply, up north, better than usual. We are still waiting for the evening grosbeaks and the Bohemian waxwings to come south. We have had another northern visitor though, in the form of a great gray owl, with us for the past two weeks. It has been just south of Carleton Place in the Blacks Corners area, and not always in the same place. One must look for it, the same as looking for the bald eagle that has been around Carleton Place in December. My friend Georgina Doe and I have searched for the eagle, and she saw the great gray, so we must still keep an eye out for the eagle. Twice I've looked for the owl, but no luck.

It is time to catch up on bird news from before Christmas, to prepare for

the new year. December 21 was a good day to see the bald eagle perched on a tree over the Mississippi River, in Carleton Place, by the McNeely Avenue bridge. Our friend Jane Henderson saw it. My husband noted a small flock of snow buntings over the Clayton Road. In Almonte, Gil and Libby Goddard had 11 cardinals in the backyard around the feeders. A lovely splash of color against the snow. The following day, also in Almonte, Reva Dolgoy called to report more than 15 mourning doves in a backyard tree. On Christmas Day, Beverley Relfe had a male ring-necked pheasant come into her yard, and he stayed through Boxing Day. Too big to be a 'partridge in a pear tree'.

Following the bird counts, Mike Jaques called to tell us that the great gray owl had moved over towards the new Beckwith Public School

area, on December 29. I went to look the next day, but did not see it. On December 30, our friend, Peter Richardson and his wife, Jennifer, from the Perth area, called to say that as they enjoyed a morning coffee in their sunroom, a great blue heron flew over their yard.

Now that's a cold bird, looking for a snack! Driving into Ottawa, Pat Doyle, of Almonte, called to tell us of a large dark hawk that flew across the highway. From the very detailed description that he gave to Cliff, the hawk was definitely a dark phase rough-legged hawk. These hawks are here for their winter visits and there are quite a number of them to be seen, both the light and dark phases.

In Almonte, on the open part of the river, a lone Canada goose is still foraging for meals. Sheila and Win MacIntosh reported the loner to me. On New Year's Day the regulars are coming to our feeders.

It is my turn to thank all of our readers for the bird reports and questions that you have given us. Please keep the bird news coming. I thoroughly enjoy finding out what birds are in our area, and telling about them. Happy Birding!

Letters

From page 4

By no means is this an exhaustive list. These activities are above and beyond a teacher's core job which is preparing for teaching, teaching, evaluating, reporting, adapting curriculum to students' individual needs, adopting new curricula, taking professional development courses, and dealing with discipline problems, and, in Catholic Schools, inculcating students with Catholic beliefs, morals and practice. Do people ever stop to wonder how teachers can accomplish all of these

tasks in a twenty-four day while maintaining a semblance of normal family life at home? Teaching is known to be one of the highest stress professions. And, although the general perception in the public often points to holidays, "short" work days, and high pay, the stresses of the job more than compensate for these perks. We are not witnessing a glut of applicants to teachers' colleges; conversely, we are facing a teacher shortage crisis.

As teachers, we are sick and tired of more and more expectations with less and less time to do the job. Year

after year at the negotiating table we are asked to make more sacrifices for Catholic education. Meanwhile, we see our ability to do our jobs well deteriorating. We see students who we'd like to help falling through the cracks, because of the time constraints put upon us. And we see our families neglected and our health failing.

If you want to see our education system fail and the spirit of teaching broken, then allow the board and the ministry to take away the basic essentials necessary to do the job well.

The public's favorite pastime of late, with much thanks to Mr. Harris, has been teacher bashing. Perhaps the temporary teacher sanctions against this board, meant to help negotiate fair and sustainable working conditions (conditions which impact on the quality of education that can be delivered), can serve to wake up the public to all the under-appreciated extras that teachers do for their children on a daily basis.

Peter Peckham, President
Eastern Ontario Catholic Teachers